

Cat Litter Box Rescue Guide — Action Checklist

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SCHEDULE YOUR VET VISIT FIRST

- ☐ **Schedule Your Vet Visit First:** Book a vet appointment immediately and request a urinalysis and bloodwork to rule out medical causes, since urinary tract infections, kidney disease, and diabetes are common and treatable reasons for inappropriate urination.
- ☐ **Schedule Your Vet Visit First:** Tell your veterinarian that your adult cat has started urinating outside the litter box and ask specifically for an urinalysis to check for infection, crystals, or blood in the urine sample.
- ☐ **Schedule Your Vet Visit First:** For male cats especially, mention any straining, crying during urination, or producing only small amounts of urine immediately to your vet, since FLUTD can become life-threatening within hours if it causes a blockage.
- ☐ **Schedule Your Vet Visit First:** Budget \$100-\$300 for the vet visit and testing, which is a worthwhile investment compared to the cost of replacing damaged flooring or carpeting in your home.

AUDIT YOUR LITTER BOX SETUP

- ☐ **Audit Your Litter Box Setup:** Count your current litter boxes and implement the N+1 rule by ensuring you have one box per cat plus one additional box, since cats naturally avoid sharing elimination space due to their territorial instincts.
- ☐ **Audit Your Litter Box Setup:** Replace any covered litter boxes with uncovered ones immediately, because covered boxes trap ammonia fumes that make the litter box experience unpleasant and create opportunities for ambush when another cat waits at the exit.
- ☐ **Audit Your Litter Box Setup:** Measure your cat from nose to base of tail and purchase or create a box that is 1.5 times that length, which means most standard store-bought boxes are far too small for adult cats.
- ☐ **Audit Your Litter Box Setup:** Fill the box with 2 inches of unscented clumping litter, scoop it daily, and perform a complete litter change weekly to eliminate odor buildup that may be driving your cat away from the box.

REDUCE STRESS TRIGGERS

- ☐ **Reduce Stress Triggers:** Install a Feliway diffuser in the room where your cat spends the most time, replacing the refill every 30 days and allowing a full 2-3 weeks before evaluating whether the calming pheromones are reducing your cat's anxiety.
- ☐ **Reduce Stress Triggers:** Add vertical space throughout your home with cat trees, wall shelves, or window perches positioned in quiet areas, since cats feel safer and more secure when they can observe their environment from an elevated position.
- ☐ **Reduce Stress Triggers:** Place cardboard boxes with blankets or covered cat beds in multiple rooms to give your cat private hiding spots where they can retreat when feeling anxious or stressed throughout the day.
- ☐ **Reduce Stress Triggers:** Dedicate 10-15 minutes daily to active play sessions using interactive toys like feather wands or laser pointers, which significantly reduces general anxiety and stress that may be contributing to the elimination problem.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.